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WAKABA LIFE INSURANCE CO., LTD.

CONFIDENTIAL — REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

“Wakaba NEXT”

Policy Administration System Migration: Independent QA & Test Execution

Client: Wakaba Life Insurance Co., Ltd.
PowerBuilder → React + Spring

Request for Proposal

“Wakaba NEXT” — Policy Administration System Migration: Independent QA & Test Execution

Issuer	Wakaba Life Insurance Co., Ltd. — IT Modernization Office, Osaka, Japan
RfP Reference	WLI-2026-013
Issue Date	31 July 2026
Written Q&A Window or Grooming, Q&A Session	31st July – 1 August 2026, closing 10:00 BST
Proposal Deadline	1 August 2026, 13:00 BST , to our procurement folder; late proposals are accepted but recorded as late.
Presentation	1 August 2026, 14:00 BST — 10 minutes per vendor, strictly enforced, in English.
Contact	Questions in writing only (nadim.hossain@bjitgroup.com); answers are shared in writing with all Proponents, and verbal exchanges are non-binding.

This document is confidential and provided solely for preparing a proposal. Budget information will not be disclosed.

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1. About Wakaba Life Insurance

Wakaba Life Insurance Co., Ltd. (“KLI”) is a mid-size life insurance company headquartered in Osaka, Japan. It serves approximately 2.1 million in-force policyholders nationwide through appointed agents, bancassurance partners and direct-mail channels. WLI is regulated under Japan's Insurance Business Act and supervised by the Financial Services Agency (FSA). Protecting policyholder data, calculating figures accurately, and keeping a clear audit trail are top priorities for WLI.

WLI's core policy administration system, “P-CORE,” has run on PowerBuilder client-server technology since 2001. It remains the backbone of new business, underwriting, policy servicing, billing and agent commission processing. P-CORE is an internal, staff-facing system used by roughly 600 head-office operations staff. Branch terminals serving WLI's approximately 3,000 appointed agents can access it only in a limited, read-only capacity; it is not a public-facing system.

WLI works with offshore development and QA partners through its group's global sourcing arm; this engagement will be executed remotely in English.

2. Background — Modernizing a 25-Year-Old Core System

P-CORE was built in PowerBuilder (versions 9 through 12.5) over more than two decades. It now comprises an estimated 1.2 million lines of PowerScript across 400+ windows and embedded DataWindow objects, running against an Oracle database. Fewer engineers know how to maintain PowerScript each year, and the platform cannot connect to WLI's newer digital-agent and claims systems. WLI's IT Modernization Office has therefore approved a multi-phase program to rebuild P-CORE on a React front end and a Spring Boot back end. The new system is internally named “P-NEXT.”

All design and coding for P-NEXT — front end, back end and data migration — is being carried out by WLI's internal engineering team together with its primary development partner. This is fixed and is not part of the present request (see Section 5). What WLI is now soliciting is an independent Quality Assurance partner to plan and execute testing across the migration, module by module, so that functional behavior, calculations and data are verified before each cutover and before the legacy P-CORE environment is retired.

Foundational platform work (AWS environment provisioning, the CI/CD pipeline, and the core P-NEXT application framework — authentication, base navigation, and shared services) preceded this RfP as internal engineering preparation; no QA vendor was engaged for it.

This RfP covers Release 1 of the program — the core policy-servicing modules described in Appendix B. The legacy infrastructure and database licensing supporting P-CORE is contracted through 31 March 2027 and will not be renewed. Full cutover of the modules in scope must be complete, and P-CORE decommissioned, before that date. This date is fixed.

3. Objectives

- Independently verify that each migrated module of P-NEXT behaves equivalently to P-CORE for all in-scope business rules, calculations and data, before it goes live.
- Catch functional regressions and integration defects before they reach WLI's operations staff or agents.
- Validate integration between P-NEXT and adjacent systems (claims interface, reinsurance, regulatory reporting, core accounting, agent commission).
- Support WLI's own User Acceptance Testing and provide the sign-off evidence WLI's compliance and actuarial teams require before retiring P-CORE.

- Build a regression safety net, automated where practical, that WLI can keep running after go-live.

4. Scope of Work Requested from the Vendor

WLI requests a proposal covering independent QA services across the remaining migration: test planning and test case design, System Testing (ST), System Integration Testing (SIT), Scenario Testing, Regression Testing, and support for WLI's User Acceptance Testing (UAT), together with defect management and reporting. WLI's own engineering team performs all development (Section 5). The vendor's job is to test it, not build it.

4.1 Test Levels Requested (Definitions)

Level	What it means for this engagement
ST — System Testing	Functional testing of each migrated module in isolation against agreed specifications and against P-CORE's observed behavior, including boundary, negative and calculation checks.
SIT — System Integration Testing	End-to-end testing across P-NEXT and its integration points — claims interface, reinsurance interface, regulatory/statutory reporting extracts, core accounting, agent commission feed, and batch/EOD processing.
Scenario Testing	Full business-scenario testing that walks a policy across its lifecycle (quotation → underwriting → issuance → endorsement → renewal/lapse → claim interface → cancellation) as an operator or agent would experience it.
Regression Testing	Re-verification, at every sprint and before every cutover, that previously working functionality (including modules already live in P-NEXT) has not broken; automation is expected to carry the bulk of this over time.
UAT Support	WLI's own operations, actuarial and compliance staff execute UAT; the vendor prepares scripts/data, staffs an embedded support desk, and triages/retests defects raised during that period. The vendor does not execute UAT itself.

4.2 Mandated / Expected QA Stack

Layer	Mandated / Expected
Test management & defect tracking	Jira (WLI's existing instance) is mandated; vendor proposes the test-management layer on top (e.g., Xray, Zephyr, or TestRail) — must integrate with Jira.
Automation	Vendor proposes the framework (e.g., Playwright or Selenium for the React front end; REST-assured / Postman-Newman for the Spring APIs); must run inside WLI's existing GitLab CI pipeline.
Parity / comparison method	Vendor proposes an approach for verifying calculation-heavy modules produce output equivalent to P-CORE (e.g., parallel-run / golden-master comparison); method and tooling to be justified in the proposal.
Environments	ST, SIT and UAT environments are provisioned on AWS by WLI's infrastructure team; the vendor is granted access but does not own or provision environments.

Layer	Mandated / Expected
Test data	Masked, production-representative policy data; handling to be agreed with WLI's compliance team (see Section 5).
Reporting	Weekly QA status report plus a release-level test-summary report; defect taxonomy and severity/priority scale to be agreed in Sprint 0.

4.3 Methodology

- Test cycles are synchronized to WLI's development team's 2-week sprints. Test case design begins as each module's requirements are confirmed — targeting one sprint ahead of coding where documentation is sufficient, though for modules requiring SME-dependent reverse-engineering (see Appendix A, SME availability) design may run closer to, or briefly overlap with, the start of coding. ST is executed in the same sprint the module is coded, SIT is held at each integration milestone, and a full regression pass runs before every module cutover.
- The QA team is organizationally independent from the development team and is not required to run identical Agile ceremonies. Vendors should propose their own internal delivery model (e.g., Scrum, Kanban, or a hybrid) — what's required is that QA's own cycle boundaries line up with the dev team's 2-week sprint boundaries above, and that QA attends the dev team's sprint planning and sprint review as an observer/contributor, not that QA's internal ceremonies mirror the dev team's exactly.
- A short Sprint 0 (test strategy, environment access, Definition of Ready/Done, backlog alignment with the dev team) is acceptable within the overall schedule.
- Defects are triaged jointly with the development team at an agreed cadence; retest turnaround and severity-based SLAs are to be proposed by the vendor and agreed with WLI.

4.4 Expected Deliverables

Across the engagement, the vendor is expected to produce and maintain:

- Test Strategy / Test Plan — approach, scope, environments and schedule, refreshed per module batch
- Test Case Repository — designed test cases with requirement/module traceability
- Defect / Bug Reports — logged, triaged, and tracked through to closure
- Test Summary / Closure Reports — per module batch, and a final report at cutover sign-off
- Requirement-to-Test Traceability Matrix — mapping requirements to test cases and execution status

See §7 for the language these should be produced in, and §10 for what the proposal itself must state about their cadence and format.

5. Items Retained by WLI (Out of Vendor Scope)

- All development: front-end (React), back-end (Spring Boot), and data-migration script development and execution — carried out by WLI's internal engineering team and its primary development partner.
- Environment provisioning and infrastructure ownership (AWS) — WLI's infrastructure team.
- Requirement specification and target-state business rule documentation — WLI's Modernization Office and actuarial team, though legacy business-rule knowledge is only partially documented.

- Execution of UAT itself — WLI's operations, actuarial and compliance staff (vendor supports only, per 4.1).
- Final go-live / cutover approval and legacy system decommissioning decision.

Vendors must state in the proposal how they will manage dependencies on the items above.

6. Functional Requirements — Test Scope by Module

The modules to be tested in this phase and their expected functions are elaborated in Appendix B. M-04 (Premium Billing & Collection Parity), M-09 (Batch / EOD & Month-End Processing) and M-12 (Role-Based Access & Audit Trail) are mandatory for this phase's sign-off and cannot be descoped. The list represents WLI's current understanding; vendors should confirm and refine open points in writing during the RfP period. WLI's internal estimate is approximately 215 testable screens across the modules in Appendix B.

7. Quality & Non-Functional Requirements

Aspect	Requirement
Functional equivalence	100% of business rules and calculations classified as “must match legacy” (Appendix B) must produce output equivalent to P-CORE for equivalent inputs, evidenced by parallel-run comparison.
Test coverage	≥ 98% requirement-to-test-case traceability for in-scope modules; 100% coverage of calculation logic classified as high-risk in Appendix B.
Defect leakage	No Critical or High severity defect may reach UAT; leakage to production is tracked and reported monthly after go-live during hypercare.
Data migration verification	Vendor validates (does not execute) the migration: 100% reconciliation of a defined critical-field set across all migrated policies, plus full-record comparison on an agreed statistical sample, before UAT sign-off.
Performance	P-NEXT must sustain WLI's internal user base (~600 concurrent operations staff at peak, e.g., month-end) with 95th-percentile page response ≤ 2 seconds. The vendor owns performance testing end-to-end — tool selection, scenario design, test execution, results analysis, and evidence documentation for sign-off. WLI's infrastructure team supports by preparing the test environment (e.g., production-equivalent provisioning, network/access configuration) as requested by the vendor, but does not execute the tests themselves.
Security	Basic security checks only — role-based access control verification (tied to M-12), spot-checks of input validation on key forms, and confirmation that sensitive data is masked in logs/error messages and that HTTPS/TLS is enforced. Exhaustive security testing (a full OWASP Top 10 sweep, penetration testing, vulnerability scanning, security code review, or threat modeling) is out of scope for this QA engagement and would require a separate, dedicated security assessment if WLI needs that level of coverage. Personal and health-related policyholder data is still handled per Japan's APPI and WLI's internal data-classification policy; no unmasked production data leaves WLI's environment.
Audit trail	Every migrated screen must log user, action, before/after values and timestamp per M-12; QA must verify log completeness and tamper-evidence as part of ST/SIT.

Aspect	Requirement
Language	Japanese is the system language; QA deliverables (test cases, defect reports) may be written in English for the vendor's own use, but summary reports to WLI must be bilingual (English/Japanese) or Japanese, to be agreed.
Regulatory evidence	Test evidence for M-09 and the modules feeding statutory reporting must be retained and organized for review by WLI's compliance/actuarial team and, potentially, Japan's FSA.

8. Timeline Expectation

Milestone	Expectation
Contract & kick-off (Sprint 0 — test strategy)	Early September 2026
Test case design & ST — first module batch	September–October 2026, running alongside the dev team's early sprints
SIT — integration milestones	Ongoing, aligned to each module's integration readiness, October 2026 – January 2027
Regression suite maturity (automation)	Continuously built from Sprint 0; full core-flow regression automated by December 2026
UAT support window	February 2027
Data migration verification & sign-off	March 2027
P-CORE decommission / full cutover	31 March 2027 — fixed; delay is not acceptable (legacy infrastructure contract expires)

Vendors shall present their own sprint-level test schedule with key milestones and state any conditions attached to it.

9. Project Structure and Communication

- All communication with WLI is remote (chat and online meetings) and in English, through WLI's global sourcing coordinator. Japanese-speaking bridge support on the vendor side is welcome but not mandatory.
- WLI answers questions submitted in writing through the designated channel. Only written agreements are valid.
- Weekly progress reporting is required in addition to Scrum ceremonies. Risks, issues and dependencies must be visible in every report.
- WLI stakeholders: IT Modernization Office (QA product owner), the internal/primary development team (a peer team, not the vendor's manager), Actuarial & Compliance, legacy P-CORE subject-matter experts (SME; limited availability), and the Infrastructure Team.

10. Proposal Requirements

The proposal must be in English and contain, at minimum:

- Executive summary
- Scope of work and explicit out-of-scope statement
- Proposed QA strategy: test levels, environments, parity/comparison approach, and how AI tools will be leveraged to reduce cost and improve quality (we expect concrete, verifiable claims)
- Test automation approach and tooling justification
- Estimation with its basis, including the estimated number of test cases to be designed and the number to be automated (by module or overall), and a sprint-level test schedule with key milestones
- Meeting cadence and reporting approach
- Risk, issue and dependency management approach, including your assumptions
- Approval and version history of the proposal document
- Team structure and resource allocation plan, including test-role mix (manual / automation / domain)

Submission: upload the proposal and supporting materials to the designated procurement folder by the deadline on the cover. The presentation slot is 10 minutes and will be stopped at time.

11. Selection Criteria and Commercial Terms

- Evaluation: (a) understanding of requirements and quality of written clarification, (b) soundness and transparency of estimation and schedule, (c) QA strategy fit, coverage/traceability approach and realistic use of AI, (d) clarity of the proposal and presentation.
- No budget is disclosed. Pricing shall be presented with a clear structure and stated assumptions.
- Defects found after go-live shall be re-tested by the vendor; the automation framework and regression suite become WLI's property upon handover, and the proposal must state how long the vendor will remain available to support, extend or troubleshoot that suite after the engagement formally ends.
- Test artifacts (test cases, automation scripts, traceability matrix) become the property of WLI upon final payment.
- Any change to agreed scope shall follow a change-control procedure to be proposed by the vendor.
- WLI may request additional exploratory or ad hoc testing based on internal feedback during the project; vendors should state how such requests would be handled.

12. Appendix A — Business & Volume Assumptions

Item	Assumption
In-force policies	Approximately 2.1 million (whole life, term, endowment and medical-rider products)
New business volume	Approximately 35,000 new policies per year
Internal users	Approximately 600 head-office operations staff (concurrent peak ~600 at month-end); ~3,000 agents with limited, read-only branch-terminal access

Item	Assumption
Legacy platform size	Approx. 1.2 million lines of PowerScript; 400+ windows/DataWindow objects; Oracle database
Batch processing	Nightly batch (policy status updates, premium-due processing); month-end batch (billing, commission calculation, statutory reserve extract) — batch windows are a shared, contended resource with other IT workstreams
Related systems	Claims system “C-CORE” (a separate legacy system; interface only — not part of this modernization program), reinsurance treaty system, group accounting/GL, agent portal, regulatory reporting extract to Japan's FSA
Data migration approach	Phased, module by module, aligned to the modules in Appendix B — not a single big-bang cutover
Legacy SME availability	Two PowerBuilder / business-rule SMEs remain; limited availability alongside their day-to-day support duties

13. Appendix B — Test Scope Detail

M-04, M-09 and M-12 are mandatory for this phase. This detail represents WLI's current understanding; confirm and refine open points in writing during the RfP period.

ID	Module	Key Test Focus
M-01	New Business & Underwriting Data Capture	Quotation intake; underwriting decision rules (age/health/amount limits); duplicate-applicant detection against P-CORE's customer master; validation and calculation parity for premium quotation.
M-02	Policy Issuance & Endorsement	Policy contract generation logic; endorsement types (beneficiary change, sum-assured change, rider addition/removal) and their effective-date and premium-recalculation rules.
M-03	Renewal, Lapse & Reinstatement	Automatic renewal processing; grace-period and lapse rules; reinstatement underwriting and back-premium calculation.
M-04	Premium Billing & Collection Parity (mandatory)	Billing-cycle generation; direct-debit and agent-collection channels; pro-rata and refund calculations on cancellation — must match P-CORE's calculation basis exactly for in-force legacy contracts.
M-06	Claims Interface (interface only)	Outbound/inbound interface to C-CORE for claim notification and policy-status updates; no claims-processing logic itself.
M-07	Regulatory & Statutory Reporting	Solvency-margin and reserve-related data extracts feeding WLI's statutory filings to Japan's FSA.
M-09	Batch / EOD & Month-End Processing (mandatory)	Nightly and month-end batch jobs; job sequencing, restart/recovery behavior, and reconciliation totals.
M-11	Master Data Management	Product/rate-table versioning, agent master, and effective-dated rate changes.

ID	Module	Key Test Focus
M-12	Role-Based Access & Audit Trail (mandatory)	Role model migrated from P-CORE's internal role codes; screen- and action-level permission enforcement; audit-log completeness.
M-13	Data Migration Verification	Reconciliation of migrated policy, contract and financial records between P-CORE and P-NEXT (vendor validates results; WLI's team executes the migration itself).

Agent Commission Calculation, Reinsurance Interface, and Correspondence & Document Generation (module IDs M-05, M-08, M-10 in WLI's internal module registry) are deferred to Release 2 of the program and are not part of this release's (Release 1's) scope.

— End of Request for Proposal —